

Therizinosaurus

When scientists put together bits and pieces of therizinosaur fossils, they turned out to be some of the most bizarre-looking dinosaurs ever. They were tall with small heads, stumpy feet, and pot bellies. While their bones show they were relatives of predatory dinosaurs, their teeth and digestive system seem to have evolved to eat plants instead of meat.

Therizinosaurus

THERRY-zin-oh-SORE-us



- **When** 80–70 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Mongolia
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 26–36 ft (8–11 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Therizinosaurus was one of the bigger therizinosaurus. Its fossils were found in what is now the cold, barren Gobi Desert. During the Late Cretaceous, this region was warmer and wetter, with tall trees. Perhaps *Therizinosaurus*'s immense height helped it to gather leaves from tall trees, like a giraffe.

▲ SCISSOR HANDS

Therizinosaurus had astonishingly long claws on its hands, each measuring nearly 3 ft (1 m) long. These may have been defensive weapons used for slashing at tyrannosaurids, such as the *Tarbosaurus* shown here. They might also have been used to pull high branches down from trees.